Finance and Banking Program

Program Overview

The Bachelor of Business Administration with specialization in Finance and Banking program is carefully designed to prepare graduates for successful careers in financial management, the financial services industry, and banking.

The Program offers a balanced blend of economic and financial theories, with general and industry-specific applications, carefully designed to ensure effective financial knowledge and competence.

To obtain a Bachelor of Business Administration degree in Finance and Banking, the student must complete 99 credit hours. These hours include University requirements (UR), College requirements (CR), and Program requirements (PR). The allocation of the credit hours is shown in the following table:

BBA in Finance and Banking (99 Credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	-	-	18	12	30	30
College Requirement	3	-	38	-	41	41
Program Requirement	25	3	-	-	28	28
Total Credits	28	3	56	12	99	100

I. University Requirements (General Education)

The list of the university's required courses and their descriptions is presented in the introductory pages of the College of Business Administration section in this catalog.

II. College Requirements

The list of college-required courses and descriptions is presented on the introductory pages of the College of Business Administration section of this catalog.

III. Program Requirements

A. Mandatory Requirements

The mandatory courses in the Finance and Banking program are listed in the table below.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
BADM 485	Co-op Work Experience	1	ENGL 217; Senior Standing

BADM 490	Entrepreneurship	3	Senior Standing
BFIN 305	Introduction to Banking	3	Junior Standing
BFIN 310	Financial Markets and Institutions	3	BFIN 300
BFIN 350	Credit and Financial Analysis	3	BFIN 300
BFIN 400	Financial Management II	3	BFIN 300
BFIN 405	Bank Financial and Risk Management	3	BFIN 305
BFIN 450	Investment Analysis	3	BFIN 400
BFIN 455	Financial Derivatives	3	Senior Standing
	Major Elective	3	

B. Major Electives

As part of the Bachelor of Business Administration in Finance and Banking program, the student must study 3 credit hours of major electives. Major electives could be upper-level courses in Finance, Banking, or closely related business areas. These courses allow students to focus on a specific area for in-depth knowledge and understanding. Meanwhile, they introduce flexibility into the program, allowing the integration of emerging topics.

In consultation with the academic advisor, the student should select the elective course that best aligns with their needs and aspirations. It is highly recommended that the student register for these courses after completing the Departmental requirements. The table below lists some recommendations for major elective courses:

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
BACC 310	Cost Accounting	3	BACC 255
BACC 470	Forensic Accounting and Fraud Detection	3	BFIN 300 and BACC 205
BADM 480	Independent Studies	3	Advisor's approval
BECN 305	Managerial Economics	3	BECN 301
BFIN 355	International Finance	3	BFIN 300, BECN 302

C. Entrepreneurship

The instructor leads the students through the detailed aspects of starting a business, from identifying an opportunity and conducting a feasibility study to preparing a business plan covering marketing, operations, and finance. Students also learn about funding, expansion, and franchising strategies. **Prerequisite:** Senior Standing.

D. Co-op Work Experience

Each student must complete 8 weeks of practical training in a field related to their interests. The Co-op experience is usually fulfilled during the summer semester of the third year in the program. The Co-op office matches the Co-op assignment with the student's field of study and the employer's interest. A faculty member follows up on a student's progress throughout the Co-op period by conducting field visits and ensuring that the student's performance is aligned with their aspirations and the employer's needs. Students must then submit formal reports and posters and make formal presentations

about their Co-op experience. While ENGL 217 and Senior Standing are prerequisites for co-op training, the program must stipulate additional conditions.

Career Opportunities

The Finance and Banking program equips students with the skills and competencies to pursue and succeed in career opportunities across organizations and vibrant industries, including banking, insurance, investments, and financial services. Possible career opportunities include financial manager, credit analyst, loan officer, branch manager, trust officer, mortgage banker, financial analyst, investment advisor, and financial planner.

Program Goals and Student Learning Outcomes

The purpose of the Finance and Banking Program at the College of Business Administration of Rafik Hariri University is an integrative composite of four main dimensions: Specialized and General Business Knowledge, Communication, Critical Thinking, and Growth Potential.

General & Specialized Business Knowledge

Goal 1	Prepare graduates with professional competence in critical finance and banking tasks and activities.
Outcome 1	Apply essential business knowledge and skills in problem-solving and decision-making.
Outcome 2	Apply financial theory to evaluate investments and alternatives in terms of performance and risk.

Communication

Goal 2	Equip graduates with the knowledge and skills to secure placements in financial and banking roles.
Outcome 3	Demonstrate written and oral English communication skills adequate for challenging entry- and middle-level professional positions and self-employment.

Critical thinking

Goal 3	Promote analytical and critical thinking in approaching business issues and problems.
Outcome 4	Identify business problems, analyze them, and present plausible solutions.

Ethics and Social Responsibility

Goal 4	Raise awareness about ethics and social responsibility to promote better business for a better community.

Outcome 5	Recognize ethical dilemmas in business and respond to them in accordance with standard codes of conduct, ethical principles, and best practices.

Study Plan

The Bachelor of Business Administration in Finance and Banking encompasses 99 credit hours over six semesters and two summer sessions. The second summer session should be dedicated to the Community Engagement Experience. Meanwhile, the third summer session should be for the Co-op work experience. The following study plan serves as a roadmap for a smooth progression toward graduation.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
Year 1, Fall Semester (16 Credits)			
BACC 205	Financial Accounting	3	
BADM 215	Personal Development and Management	1	
BMGT 200	Introduction to Management	3	Co-req.: ENGL 210.
BITM 200	Information Technology Essentials	3	
ENGL 210	English Composition and Rhetoric	3	Placement
MATH 207	College Algebra*	3	Placement
Year 1, Spring Semester (16 Credits)			
BACC 255	Managerial Accounting	3	BACC 205
BADM 225	Business Math	3	Placement
BADM 235	Business Research Methodology	1	
BADM 250	Business Statistics	3	
BMKA 200	Introduction to Marketing	3	Co-req.: ENGL 210
ENGL 217	Professional English Communication	3	ENGL 210
Year 2, Fall Semester (18 Credits)			
BADM 230	Business Law	3	
BECN 301	Microeconomics	3	Junior Standing
BFIN 300	Financial Management I	3	BACC 205
BFIN 305	Intro to Banking	3	Junior Standing
BITM 300	Business IT Management	3	BITM 200
	Science Elective	3	
Year 2, Spring Semester (18 Credits)			
BECN 302	Macroeconomics	3	Junior Standing
BFIN 310	Financial Markets and Institutions	3	BFIN 300
BFIN 350	Credit and Financial Analysis	3	BFIN 300
BFIN 400	Financial Management II	3	BFIN 300
BITM 350	Fundamentals of Data Analytics	3	BADM 250 or MATH 351.
	Humanities / Fine Arts Elective	3	

Year 2, Summer Semester (0 Credits)			
BADM 290	Community Engagement Experience	0	
Year 3, Fall Semester (15 Credits)			
BADM 355	Business Ethics and Social Responsibility	3	Junior Standing
BADM 420	Quantitative Methods for Business	3	BADM 250 or MATH 351 or Senior Standing
BFIN 405	Bank Financial and Risk Management	3	BFIN 305
BFIN 450	Investment Analysis	3	BFIN 400
	Social Science Elective	3	
Year 3, Spring Semester (15 Credits)			
ARAB 212	Arabic Language and Communication	2	
BADM 490	Entrepreneurship	3	Senior Standing
BFIN 455	Financial Derivatives	3	Senior Standing
	Community & Sustainability	1	Co-req.: ENGL 210
	Major Elective	3	
	Social Science Elective	3	
Year 3, Summer Semester (1 Credit)			
BADM 485	Co-op Work Experience	1	ENGL 217; Senior Standing

* Students exempted from this course based on their score on the mathematics placement exam will select a free elective course as a substitute for it.

Courses Description

I. Mandatory Courses

Descriptions of the major mandatory courses are given below.

BADM 485	**Co-op Work Experience**	**1(0,1)**
The first Co-op work experience is designed to provide students with full-time work terms in business, industry, or government. The main thrust of this course is the opportunity to put into practice the major aspects of the student's business education. Special emphasis will be placed on assessing the student's attitude and work ethic. Students will be encouraged to network in the industry and to participate in professional organizations. **Prerequisite:** ENGL 217; Senior Standing.		

BADM 490	**Entrepreneurship**	**3(3,0)**
The instructor leads the students through the detailed aspects of starting a business, from identifying an opportunity and conducting a feasibility study to preparing a business plan covering marketing, operations, and finance. Students also learn about funding, expansion, and franchising strategies. **Prerequisite:** Senior Standing.		

BFIN 305	Introduction to Banking	3(3,0)
This course provides students with a comprehensive understanding of bank management, emphasizing key hard skills essential for success in the banking sector. Topics include asset-liability management, risk management practices, effective financial strategy formulation, and performance evaluation of banking institutions. The course also covers banking regulations, the development of banking systems, and an analysis of products and services offered by banks. Students will explore the internal organization and structure of banks, equipping them with the necessary tools to navigate the complexities of the banking environment. **Prerequisite**: Junior Standing.		

BFIN 310	Financial Markets and Institutions	3(3,0)
This course provides a comprehensive exploration of financial markets and institutions, focusing on equity market organization, security market indices, and market efficiency, and examining their implications for investors and policymakers. It also covers fixed-income securities and markets, including issuance, trading mechanisms, funding strategies, and the term structure of interest rates. In addition to traditional financial systems, the course introduces emerging topics in finance, such as machine learning and artificial intelligence in financial analysis, cryptocurrencies, and digital assets, highlighting their impact on market structure and investment strategies. By integrating fundamental concepts with evolving financial technologies, this course equips students with the knowledge and analytical tools needed to navigate today's dynamic global financial environment. **Prerequisite**: BFIN 300.		

BFIN 350	Credit and Financial Analysis	3(3,0)
This course provides a comprehensive introduction to financial reporting and analysis. It covers the structure and interpretation of financial statements, including the balance sheet, income statement, and cash flow statement, along with key accounting principles, revenue recognition, inventory valuation, and long-term asset accounting. Participants will learn financial ratio analysis, assess financial reporting quality, and explore the impact of different accounting policies under IFRS and U.S. GAAP. The course equips learners with the skills to analyze financial statements, detect red flags in reporting, and make informed investment and credit decisions. **Prerequisite**: BFIN 300.		

BFIN 400	Financial Management II	3(3,0)
This course provides a comprehensive introduction to corporate finance. It covers fundamental concepts such as capital budgeting, cost of capital, capital structure, working capital management, and measures of corporate performance. Participants will explore financial decision-making frameworks, risk and return analysis, dividend policy, and the impact of leverage on a firm's financial health. Additionally, the course will delve into environmental, social, and governance (ESG) factors and their significance in corporate governance, highlighting how these elements influence financial strategies and stakeholder expectations. By the end, learners will develop the skills to assess corporate financial strategies, optimize capital allocation, and make informed investment and financing decisions while considering ESG principles and effective governance practices. **Prerequisite:** BFIN 300.		

BFIN 405	Bank Financial and Risk Management	3(3,0)
This course provides a comprehensive introduction to financial and risk management in banking, focusing on the key principles of asset and liability management. Students will explore fixed-income risk and return, with an emphasis on duration, convexity, and the impact of interest rate movements on bond pricing and portfolio management. The course covers the fundamentals of credit analysis, including credit risk assessment, credit spreads, and default probabilities. Additional topics include liquidity and capital adequacy management, market risk, operational risk, and regulatory compliance. Students will also examine key risk measurement techniques, such as Value-at-Risk (VaR) and stress testing, as well as the role of money market operations in financial stability. By integrating theoretical concepts with real-world applications, this course prepares students to analyze and manage financial risks in banking institutions effectively. **Prerequisite**: BFIN 305		

BFIN 450	Investment Analysis	3(3,0)
This course introduces students to the fundamental principles of portfolio management, focusing on investment selection, risk assessment, and portfolio construction. Students will explore key topics such as risk-return trade-offs, diversification, and asset allocation strategies. The course covers portfolio risk management techniques, including systematic and unsystematic risk, beta, and standard deviation, and examines portfolio performance evaluation methods. Additionally, students will learn the basics of portfolio planning and construction, incorporating principles of asset allocation, rebalancing, and investment objectives. By integrating theoretical frameworks with real-world applications, this course prepares students to develop effective investment strategies in various market conditions. **Prerequisite**: BFIN 400		

BFIN 455	Financial Derivatives	3(3,0)
This course introduces students to financial derivatives and their applications in risk management, corporate strategy, and investment decision-making. Students will learn how derivatives can be used for hedging and speculation, with a focus on instruments such as forwards, futures, options, and swaps. Particular emphasis is placed on their role in foreign exchange trading and financial risk mitigation. Additionally, the course provides an introduction to alternative investments, including private equity, hedge funds, real estate, commodities, and structured products. Students will explore the risk-return characteristics of these assets and their role in portfolio diversification. By integrating derivatives and alternative investments, this course equips students with a comprehensive understanding of modern financial instruments and their strategic applications. **Prerequisite:** Senior Standing.		

II. Elective Courses

Descriptions of some major elective courses are given below.

BACC 310	Cost Accounting	3(3,0)
This course introduces students to the basic concepts, analyses, uses, and procedures of management accounting. This course would enable students to understand and view cost as part of activities planned and implemented by a company. It covers cost categories, cost behavior, cost-volume-profit analysis, master and flexible budgets, direct costs and manufacturing overhead variances, and inventory cost systems. **Prerequisite:** BACC 255.		

BACC 470	Forensic Accounting and Fraud Detection	3(3,0)
This course will cover the basic concepts of forensic accounting. Topics include detecting, preventing, investigating, and resolving various types of fraud. The course covers many types of financial statement fraud, including asset misappropriation, fraudulent financial statements, tax fraud, and electronic fraud. **Prerequisite**: BFIN 300 and BACC 205.		

BADM 480	Independent Studies	3(3,0)
This course focuses on advancing the student's knowledge in their specialization through independent research and application on current or emerging topics, as approved by the assigned faculty member. **Prerequisite:** Advisor's approval.		

BECN 305	Managerial Economics	3(3,0)
Given the constraints firms face, this course applies microeconomic theory to various management and planning decisions, such as output maximization and cost minimization. Demand analysis, cost analysis, and different market structures are studied. **Prerequisite:** BECN 301.		

BFIN 355	International Finance	3(3,0)
This course exposes students to international financial management and trade from the perspective of managers working in international corporations. Topics include the management of foreign exchange exposure, foreign investments, multinational capital budgeting, the balance of payments, determination of exchange rates, and international banking. **Prerequisite:** BFIN 300, BECN 302.		